

# BALAAJEE V.R.

## Senior UI/UX Design Manager

- Immediate Availability
- Open to India / Global Relocation


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Chennai / Bengaluru, India

LinkedIn Profile ↗


| 18+ Years | 50+ | 100% | 25+ | 8+ | 10M+ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| in Product Design | Designers Mentored | Team Retention | Products Shipped | Industry Domains | Users Impacted |

### Senior UI/UX Design Manager

Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

**IBM India Software Labs**

Agentic AI UX | Human-in-the-Loop | Design System Governance | Org Restructuring

- Spearheaded the UX transformation of enterprise B2B platforms by integrating generative AI and agentic workflows (IBM watsonx), cutting complex task completion from **14.2 hours to 3.6 hours**.
- Restructured and scaled a multidisciplinary organization of **14+ UI/UX designers** into an agile **UX-as-a-Service model**, establishing career ladders, advancing 2 designers into lead tracks, and maintaining **100% retention**.
- Directed the UX architecture for AI confidence thresholds and automated security remediation workflows, cutting threat triage from **4.1 hours to 43 minutes** across 140,000+ enterprise tasks.
- Embedded AI tools into day-to-day DesignOps — upskilling the team, leading cross-functional AI-UX workshops, and driving **IBM Carbon Design System** adoption across US and European squads to accelerate design-to-dev handoff.

### UI/UX Product Design Manager

Jul 2021 – Aug 2024

**Zebra Technologies**

Enterprise Mobility & IoT | Lean UX & PI Planning | Multi-Device Design Systems | UX & Content Team Scaling

- Directed end-to-end UX across B2B mobile hardware and cloud consoles (**38,000+ rugged Android endpoints**), delivering gloved-touch workflows that cut scanner pairing failures by **84%** and support tickets by **33%**.
- Shaped multi-year product roadmaps with global enterprise accounts and sales leadership, synthesizing field research and competitive insights to shift the org from reactive feature delivery to strategic innovation.
- Championed **Lean UX** and quarterly **Agile/PI planning** workshops across global engineering squads, resolving technical constraints early and standardizing multi-device design systems to cut UI rework.
- Built and led a multidisciplinary team of **UI/UX and Content Designers** from the ground up — owning end-to-end hiring loops, global capacity allocation, mentoring, and career progression.

### UI/UX Senior Specialist

Oct 2020 – Jul 2021

**ZF Wabco**

Commercial Vehicle HMI | Fleet Telematics | Driver Safety Ergonomics | Usability & Heatmap Research

- Spearheaded UX strategy for commercial vehicle digital cockpits, infotainment, and fleet tracking platforms in collaboration with German engineering HQ.
- Cut average driver glance duration from **2.8s to 0.94s** (below the 1.2s safety threshold) by architecting a 3-tier alert hierarchy and high-contrast day/night cockpit UI standards.
- Led cross-functional alignment across product and engineering, leveraging **heatmap analytics**, contextual driver research, and simulator testing to reduce critical navigation errors by **18%** across **80,000+ vehicles**.

### UI/UX Designer

Jul 2019 – Sep 2020

**Ericsson Global**

5G CPQ Platform | High-Density Data Viz | UX Strategy Workshops | Information Architecture

- Replaced a fragmented 14-tab legacy Excel pricing workflow with a unified, keyboard-first enterprise **5G CPQ platform** — cutting quote turnaround from **6 days to 42 minutes** and achieving **94% adoption**.
- Partnered with Swedish and global stakeholders to lead UX discovery workshops and user research, translating complex 5G telecom pricing rules into clean information architecture.
- Standardized high-density data visualization patterns and reusable UI components within the **Ericsson Design System**, streamlining global engineering handoffs.

### Lead UI/UX Designer

Sep 2017 – Jul 2019

**NP Compete Technologies**

Client UX Roadmaps | Stakeholder Workshops | UI Pattern Libraries | Design Team Leadership

- Led customer requirement-gathering sessions as primary UX liaison, translating complex business needs into strategic, actionable product design roadmaps.
- Facilitated stakeholder UX workshops and rigorous market research to establish foundational style guides, reusable UI pattern libraries, and robust information architecture.
- Directed end-to-end product design cycles — managing sprint planning, resource allocation, and a team of UI/UX designers to deliver high-fidelity interactive prototypes on schedule.

## EARLIER EXPERIENCE

### Freelance UI/UX Designer

May 2015 – Aug 2017

Designed end-to-end mobile applications, responsive web platforms, interactive wireframes, and usability flows for international startup and SMB clients.

### Creative Head

May 2010 – Apr 2015

**Titi Technologies**

Led a multidisciplinary creative team across digital product UI, brand identity systems, and interactive mobile application experiences from concept to App Store launch.

### Senior Software Engineer

Jan 2006 – Apr 2010

**Infosys Technologies**

Developed, customized, and tested enterprise banking software modules for Finacle Universal Banking, building a strong technical foundation in front-end engineering and enterprise workflows.




### PEOPLE & ORG MANAGEMENT

**Hiring & Scaling:** End-to-end interview loops, portfolio evaluations & onboarding.

**Performance & Growth:** Career ladders, promotions, performance turnaround & 1:1 coaching.

**DesignOps & Delivery:** UX-as-a-Service capacity planning, PI planning & design critiques.

**Global Collaboration:** Direct alignment across US, German, Swedish & Indian hubs.

### EXPERTISE

**Strategy:** Product Vision, Service Blueprints, Multi-Brand Design Systems.

**Research:** Contextual Inquiry, Simulator & Lab Usability Testing, Journey Mapping, Heuristic Audits.

**Execution:** Information Architecture, Complex B2B Workflows, Engineering Handoff.

### INDUSTRY DOMAINS

- Enterprise AI & SaaS
- Industrial IoT & Mobility
- Automotive & Telematics
- 5G Telecom & CPQ
- Healthcare Systems
- Core Banking & FinTech

### TOOLS & GOVERNANCE

**AI Tools:** Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, IBM watsonx, Google Stitch, NotebookLM, Google AI Studio, Gemini.

**Design:** Figma, Miro, Mural, Adobe Creative Cloud.

**Operations:** Jira, Monday.com, Confluence, Dual-Track Agile.

**Research:** UserTesting, Hotjar, Google Analytics.

**Governance:** Enterprise Accessibility, Design System Governance, AI Human-Oversight, Data Privacy.

### AWARDS

**Ericsson:** Spot Award for UX innovation culture & 1st Place in Global Hack-fest Contest.

**Infosys:** 3rd Place Winner & Best Project Nominee, Telstra Annual Excellence Awards.

**Samsung:** Sponsored for 10-Year US Business Visa to lead global healthcare UX research.

**Consumer Impact:** Designed *"Greedy Jump"* iOS game achieving 80,000+ organic downloads.

**UX Challenges:** 1st Place Winner in MockingBOT & UP Labs Global Design Contests.

### EDUCATION

**B.E. Information Technology**

MS University